CONSTITUTION OF THE ROTARACT MULTI DISTRICT INFORMATION ORGANIZATION (MDIO) OF ROTARACT SOUTH ASIA

[Drafted 26th June 2020]

[Adopted 1st July 2020]

Article 1: Name

The full and official name of this organization shall be **Rotaract South Asia Multi District Information Organization (RSAMDIO)**

Article 2: Purpose & Objectives

1. The purpose of this Rotaract MDIO is to disseminate information and facilitate communication between Rotaract clubs in the member districts.

2. Its objective to support the growth of Rotaract among its member districts shall be achieved by:
   a) Offering leadership training to the Rotaract club leaders.
   b) Organizing an annual conference for Rotaract members that are part of the member districts.
   c) Distribution of a Newsletter
   d) Information services regarding Rotaract and Rotary programs and activities; - Contact persons who relay information between the participating districts

3. This Rotaract MDIO has no governing, decision-making, or legislative powers, except for decisions concerning the activities of this organization, for which each member district (as represented by its corresponding District Rotaract Representative) shall have one vote each.
   This Rotaract MDIO exists primarily as a resource for Rotaractors and Rotarians.

4. This Rotaract MDIO shall operate under the oversight of and with the full cooperation of the governors of each member district.

5. Rotary International recognizes and terminates Rotaract MDIOs, but each Rotaract MDIO operates and is governed independently.
   Nothing in this Constitution or the Bylaws shall contravene the Rotary International Code of Policies.

Article 3: Membership

The members of this organization shall be the individual Rotary districts recognized by Rotary International to have joined this MDIO as member districts. Rotary districts interested in becoming member districts must have a District Rotaract Representative (DRR). The Bylaws shall define additional requirements and expectations for membership.

Article 4: Office of President, Board of Directors and RSA MDIO Administrative Council Officers

01. The office of President, Board of Directors and other Council Officers shall be appointed, nominated and dismissed as provided in the By-laws of the RSAMDIO.

02. The Board of Directors and RSAMDIO Council Officers shall exercise no governing power over the affairs of member districts and shall not serve as an official representative of any member district.

Article 5: Finances

01. Funds needed to implement the organization's activities (i.e. production and distribution of regional club directories and newsletters, dissemination of Rotaract program information, general correspondence) cannot be made enforceable.
02. Funds needed to implement the organization's activities that involve the participation by Rotaract clubs and/or individual Rotaractors shall be collected on a voluntary basis, clearly presented as such; the cost of participation by a club or individual Rotaractor. Funds collected, if any, should be kept to a minimum, and not be implicitly or directly made an obligation in the form of a per capita tax, or assessment or otherwise.

Article 6: By Laws

Bylaws should be consistent with both the Rotary MDIO Constitution and the Rotary International Code of Policies, embodying and additional provisions for the government of this MDIO shall be adopted initially by a majority vote of the Board and may be amended by a majority vote of member districts, subject to any exceptions prescribed by the Board.

Article 7: Name and Logo

The name and logo of Rotaract shall be used exclusively by Rotaract members. This MDIO is entitled to wear or otherwise display the Rotaract name and logo along with the proper MDIO identifier in a dignified and appropriate manner.

Article 8: Duration

This MDIO shall exist so long as it continues to function in accordance with the provisions of this constitution and policy relating to Rotaract established by Rotary International and reports a Rotaract MDIO contact annually to RI, or until it is terminated:

- By Rotary International, with or without the consent, approval or concurrence of the Board or member districts, for:
    1. failure to function in accordance with the Rotary International Code of Policies
    2. upon disaffiliation of all member districts
    3. other cause
- By itself upon its own determination.

Upon termination of this MDIO, all rights and privileges relating to the Rotaract name and logo shall be relinquished by the MDIO.

Article 9: Acceptance of Constitution and By-laws

Every member district, by acceptance of membership, thereby accepts the principles of Rotaract as expressed in its purpose and agrees to comply with the constitution and bylaws of this MDIO, and on these conditions alone is entitled to the privileges. No member shall be absolved from the observance of the Constitution and Bylaws on the plea that a copy of them has not been received.

Article 10: Amendments

1. Amendments to this Constitution may be proposed only by a member district or by the Board in accordance with the procedures contained in the Bylaws.
2. This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds vote of the member districts. Voting procedures for such amendments shall be contained in the Bylaws.

BYLAWS OF THE ROTARACT MULTI DISTRICT INFORMATION ORGANIZATION (MDIO) OF ROTARACT SOUTH ASIA

Article 1 — Definitions

1. Throughout the by-laws, unless the subject or context requires otherwise: The “area’, “region” and “member districts” shall be the Rotary International Districts affiliated to RSAMDIO from India, Nepal, Sri Lanka & Maldives, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Pakistan and Afghanistan
2. The “Representative” of every Rotary International District, part of RSAMDIO shall be the District Rotaract Representative.
3. Board: The MDIO’s board of directors and the council.
4. Governing Body: Board of Directors or the Administrative Council
5. Officer: An officer of the MDIO board of directors
6. Member District: A Rotary district affiliated to Rotaract South Asia MDIO
7. DRR: A District Rotaract representative
8. Quorum: The minimum number of participants who must be present when a vote is taken. The MDIO may choose how it defines a quorum for voting purposes.
   Majority of the MDIO’s member districts for MDIO decisions and majority of the officers for MDIO board decisions. (Majority = 2/3rd of the established quorum)
9. RI: Rotary International
10. MDIO: A Multidistrict Information Organization
11. Year: The 12-month period that begins on 1 July
    The MDIO may choose how it defines a quorum for voting purposes.

Article 2 — Elections and Terms of Office of President and Appointment of Board of Directors and Administrative Council

1. The Board shall exercise no governing power over the affairs of member districts and shall not serve as an official representative of any member district.
2. The officers shall be President, Vice-President, General Secretary and the Immediate Past President. There shall be additional board members as may be appointed by the President for the functioning of the MDIO
3. Election for the office of President shall be conducted online/offline at the annual meeting. Those elected shall take the office from 1 July of the year they have been elected for.

4. Any officer may resign by presenting an official letter of resignation to the President 15 days before the effective date of resignation. If the President resigns, an official letter of resignation must be presented to the Vice-President or another officer of the Board 30 days before the effective date of resignation.
5. If any officer vacates a position, the remaining members of the Board will appoint a replacement for the remainder of the term (if required as such).
6. Any officer may be dismissed by a 2/3 vote of the officers of the Board of Directors/ Administrative Council:
   - if the officer cannot or is unwilling to fulfil the duties of their office as described in these Bylaws;
   - if the officer does not comply with the practices outlined in the Constitution, Bylaws, or Rotary Code of Policies; or
   - For good and sufficient cause, as determined by the officers of the Board of Directors.

1. President of RSA MDIO
   a. Eligibility
      A Rotaractor shall be eligible who:
      i. is a good standing member of the Rotaract club in accordance with his/her club by-laws,
      ii. is within the age of 35 years at the time of assuming the office of President,
      iii. has served as a District Rotaract Representative for one full year,
      iv. has served RSA MDIO in the Board/Administrative council for one complete year at the time of filing the nomination form for the election.

   b. Elections:
      A candidate who has:
      i. Submitted the age proof document (Passport/Driving License/Voter ID) on/before the last date of nomination as defined by the Election Committee.
      ii. Letter of confirmation as an active Rotaractor who has served as the DRR for one full term, from the District Governor of the nominating year & District Governor of his/her DRR tenure.
      iii. Letter of confirmation as a Board/Administrative Council member who has served RSA MDIO for one complete term from the RSA MDIO President of the RI Year in which the candidate was a part of the board.
      iv. Fulfilled additional criteria as may be defined by the appointed Election Committee
   c. The duration for the office of the president shall be from July 1st to June 30th (of the RI Year) or until the incoming president has taken the office.

2. Board of Directors and Council Bearers
   a. The members of the Board of Directors shall be the President of RSA MDIO along with the General Secretary, Vice President, Treasurer, Immediate Past President and any other appointed members by the President among his/her Council officers.
   b. The President shall appoint the Board of Directors and Council Bearers from among the member districts as per his/her discretion.

Article 3 — Duties and Responsibilities of President, Board of Directors and Administrative Council

1. The Board of Directors shall oversee the financial operations, events, and programs of this MDIO. It shall hold regularly scheduled meetings, which shall be open to the attendance of any Board member in good standing. Members attending such meetings, however, shall not address the meeting except with the permission of the officers of the Board.
2. The President presides at all meetings of Board of Directors and the annual meeting. The Board of Directors shall appoint all committees and volunteer leaders as necessary or convenient,
3. The President is an ex officio member of all committees.

4. The President maintains regular communication with the member districts, the district Rotaract representatives, and Rotary International.
5. The vice-president succeeds the office of President in the event of a vacancy, and, in the absence of the President, presides at all meetings of the Board.
6. The Immediate Past President presides at all meetings of the Board in the absence of the President and Vice-President.
7. The secretary maintains all official records, records minutes of all the meetings of the Board, and provides copies of such to the members upon request.
8. The treasurer oversees all funds and provides an annual accounting of them. The treasurer shall make all disbursements under procedures determined by the Board. The treasurer shall make all records available for inspection by any member upon request.
9. RSAMDIO board meetings shall be held at any South Asian multi district event or virtually on recognized platforms.

Article 4 — Meetings of the Board of Directors/Board Members/Administrative Council

1. There shall be not less than 3 meetings of the Board each year.
2. Special meetings of the Board are called with reasonable notice by the President or upon the request of officers of the board or District Rotaract Representatives for good and sufficient cause.
3. The following shall be entitled to attend meetings of the Board:
    1. The elected officers and Board members of RSAMDIO
    2. Such other person(s) as shall be invited by the President to attend
    3. Past Presidents of Rotaract South Asia MDIO

Article 5 — Method of Admitting Member Districts

1. The members of this organization shall be the individual Rotary Districts who have joined this MDIO as member districts. To become a member district, a district must:
    a) obtain the written approval of its current district governor;
    b) have a District Rotaract Representative (DRR) reported to RI;

2. The Rotary Districts must be covered under the Rotary International Zones 1(b) 4, 5, 6 & 7.
3. The Rotary Districts must be in the geographical locations of following countries: Afghanistan & Pakistan, India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka & Maldives, Nepal & Bhutan
4. Authorization from RI's General Secretary, acting on behalf of the RI Board of Directors, is needed to officially recognize new member districts admitted to RSAMDIO.
5. Established member districts must complete and maintain all the requirements to remain eligible to vote at all official meetings.
6. A member district may opt-out of RSAMDIO by providing a signed disaffiliation form from its current district governor to RSAMDIO and Rotary International.
7. Member districts may be dismissed or removed:
    a) By the current district governor should they be found to not operate under the oversight of and with the full cooperation of the governor and/or any district policy;
    b) By the Board of Directors for failure to comply with the requirements of a member district as defined in these Bylaws;

Article 6: General/Annual Meetings

1. An annual meeting shall be held thrice in a year with the first meeting no later than the end of first quarter.
2. The location, date, time, and necessary cost to attend the annual meeting shall be announced at least 30 days prior to the meeting.

3. A quorum of members must be present before other matters, such as amendments/voting may be conducted. (Refer Article 7)
4. Each member district shall be entitled to one voting delegate for any matters or elections presented for consideration at the meeting. It shall be the duty of each member district to be represented either by its DRR or a proxy, and to vote on each proposal submitted for determination.
5. Officers of the Board of Directors are non-voting members at the meeting of the member districts.
6. Voting at the meetings shall be conducted by one of the following ways:
   a) Secret Ballot (in the event of physical meeting)
   b) E-voting (Voting by electronic poll in the event of online meeting)

   In the event of more than one delegate being present from a member district, the voting precedence is as follows:
   I. DRR
   II. DRR Elect
   III. DRR Nominee
   IV. IPDRR (Immediate Past District Rotaract Representative)
   V. Past DRR (According to seniority on basis of serving the district)
7. An annual conference for the purpose of training, fellowship, or service may also be held, and where convenient should be organized around the same time and place as the annual meeting.

Article 7: Finances

1. A budget for the forthcoming year shall be presented at the last meeting of the Board each year. The total budget figure shall then be divided equally between the Member Districts of RSAMDIO.
2. Annual accounts of the MDIO's financial transactions shall be audited by a qualified person and presented at the first meeting of the Board following the end of the year to which they relate.
3. Payment by each member district of its share (although voluntary) shall be submitted to the Treasurer not later than 30th September.
4. For the member districts unable to attend the annual meetings, the payments can be made via online mode as may be convenient to the District Rotaract Representatives and the Treasurer.

Article 8: Amendments

1. Amendments to the Constitution or Bylaws may be proposed by a member district in good standing or an officer of the Board only by sending a formal proposal to RSAMDIOs governing body, 30 days before the general meeting.
2. The Constitution or these Bylaws may be amended by majority vote of the members in good standing where quorum is present at the annual meeting or a special meeting, provided notice of intention to call such a vote is given at least 45 days earlier.
3. Changes to these Bylaws must be consistent with the Standard Rotaract Club Constitution and the Rotary International Code of Policies.
4. The following requirements must be completed before a vote can be taken and a proposal to amend be passed:
   a) Quorum
   b) Voting (Refer Article 6, Subparagraph 6)
5. Changes to these Bylaws must be consistent with the Standard Rotaract Club Constitution and the Rotary International Code of Policies.

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